

Bluff

YOUR WAY THROUGH

Talking Elite

Elite, or "I337," is the language of hackers, crackers, and those who think they are hackers and crackers. It's rarely spoken out loud, and we suggest you leave it that way—speaking I337 has become so common that it's considered "I4m3r."

Generally, while I337-ing, you can safely substitute 'ck' or 'cks' with an 'X' (h4x0r, r0x0r, etc.). Any 'F' sound becomes 'Ph', like pl-I34r (Fear). Use a 0 (zero) for 'o', a '7' or '+' for 'T', '4' for 'A', '3' for 'E', '8' for 'B', '5' for 'S', 1 for an exclamation, etc.

For practical examples, ph34r +his:

I4m3r / L4|\\|3R (Lamer):

Generally an insult.

Usage: "OMG1 you're such a I4m3r, go away before I h4x0r you."

d00d (Dude): Anyone or anything remotely human, whether male or female.

Usage: "d00d, remember that d00d we met the other day? The friend of the d00d with the yellow car! d00d, that d00d is such a I4m3r1"

H4x0r / |-|4><0r (Haxor):

Meaning "Hacker."

Usage: "That d00d says he h4x0r3d the FBI, either he's I337 or really I4m31"

r0x0r / r0><0r (roxor):

Meaning "Rocks"

Usage: "That new Linkin' Park song r0x0r51"

n00b (Noob / Newbie):

Another insult

Usage: "lol n00b1111"

w007 / w00t / \\|/00+

(Woot!): An exclamation of joy, like "Whoo Hoo!", or "Yay!", but cooler!

Usage: "w00t1 My AMD Athlon 64 FX just arrived; eat your hearts out I4m3r51"

Ph47 / pl-|4+ (phat):

This means you are cool and "with it". **Usage:** "d00d, thatz some serious programming skillz you got. Very ph47 d00d1"

YoU MaY aLsO tRy TyPiNg
LiKe ThiS, UsiNg aLErNaTe CaPs,
EsPeCiAlLy FoR yOuR
nIcKnAmEs!

Duniya Mutthi Mein?

When *Digit* decided to create a special issue on communication for November, we were a bit undecided on the cover. We certainly can't have a mobile phone on the cover, can we? It just too inanimate.

Before we went into metaphysical manifestations of communication, and what it means to mankind, we hit upon a brainwave.

About 10 km from the *Digit* office lies a 140-acre complex that goes by the name of Dhirubhai Ambani Knowledge City. The man in charge here is Mukesh Ambani—Founder, Chairman, and Managing Director of Reliance Infocomm, a company that has emerged as India's largest communications company, just 18 months after it was launched.

To put Ambani on the cover, therefore, was a no-brainer. He has the stature, he has the vision, and he is

technology savvy enough to make India a world communications superpower. The big question? Who will bell the cat? As it happens on all such occasions, this fell upon Sachin Kalbag, our Executive Editor.

Last year, when Sachin was working in *Mid Day*, he casually called up the then finance minister Jaswant Singh on a

number he got from a government Web site. Mr Singh himself picked up the phone! No such luck with

Mr Ambani; contacting him was tougher than climbing Mt Everest—he is almost always out of the office, out of town, or out of the country!

However, Sachin persevered. Hundreds of calls later, two days before deadline, success! The result of the blood, sweat, a few tears and not to mention big phone bills (OK, OK, just painful dialling and typing fingers!), is this month's cover, and the Lead Feature in *Digital Passion*.

DIGIT DIARY

comply with the universal order of stellar economics. What a shame that he will have to submit to an earthly court...

widespread deployment in public buildings in the UK and elsewhere.

The author of the report, Neil Selwyn, says that just

over the world are similar to those in the UK—which is quite likely—we will just have to accept that the Internet has not done more

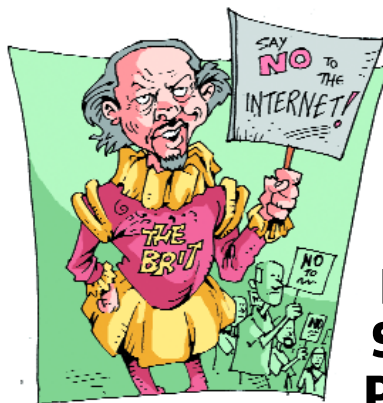
for us, in terms of learning and self-advancement, than the printed word has. And with people reading less than ever before, there is cause for global worry.

PEOPLE DUMB DESPITE NET

Surfers Go Online Just For Kicks

Here's something we knew all along: that despite the current extent of Internet penetration, despite broadband and everything that comes with it, most people do not use the Net for self-improvement and expansion—they prefer to use it for such things as "casual surfing related to hobbies and music."

This was the conclusion reached by a recent Cardiff University study, which polled 1,001 people across the UK. It shows that the concept of "lifelong learning" online doesn't exist in most peoples' heads. The number of UK adults participating in ongoing education has not increased much since the Net came by. Less than half of UK adults make use of the WWW despite its



eight per cent of the UK population does not have Internet access, and yet, surprisingly, 48 per cent had not used it during the last year. He gives an example representative of this sad finding: one man had "only used the Internet to book his holidays twice a year and that was done on his behalf by a computer-literate friend."

Selwyn concludes his report with this: "It's good to make access to the Internet as wide as possible, so that no one is left behind, but we have to accept that not everyone needs it in their lives." If Internet usage patterns all

RENT-AN-IPOD

Hotels Serve Up Portable Devices

Here's something Steve Jobs would love to listen to: the latest trend in hotels is making iPods available for guests. One among these is Las Ventanas al Paraíso in Los Cabos, Mexico, which lets guests chill out on the poolside with their own iPods. The devices are served full of over a 1,000 songs, ranging from Latin jazz and classic rock to hip-hop. Reports have not indicated whether one can add to the preset list.